Ashwin Sathian

Senior Full-Stack Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Eight years building SaaS platforms, five of them at one company. I take a customer's raw ask, turn it into a spec, and build the thing myself, start to finish. Joined Penny Software as a founding engineer and stayed through its growth into a procurement platform moving $1B+ a year, architecting the Angular/NestJS/MongoDB stack that holds sub-200ms queries at that scale.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend: Angular, React, Next.js • **Backend:** TypeScript, Node.js, NestJS, Express, Go, REST APIs • **Database:** MongoDB, Redis • **Cloud & DevOps:** GCP, AWS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Nx, Playwright • **AI tooling:** Claude Code, OpenAI Codex • System Design • SaaS Architecture • Multi-tenancy • RBAC • Agile & Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HighLevel | Mar 2026 – Jun 2026

- **Lead Engineer**
  - Owned Funnels, Websites and Webinars under a model where each engineer ran the full SDLC alone, AI-augmented, operating as full-stack builders
  - Reworked the reverse proxy engine that serves the websites and funnels built through the platform to be more performant and resilient to handle cache purges and downtime

Penny Software | Jun 2020 – Aug 2025

- **Lead Engineer | Jan 2024 – Aug 2025**
  - Owned platform architecture for a modular SaaS procurement system that grew to $1B+ GTV across millions of records, and mentored the 12-person team building it.
  - Designed, expanded and augmented the tech stack to hold sub-200ms queries at that scale.
  - Sat with a customer who was vetting vendors by hand, distilled the spec, then built and owned a Vendor Pre-Qualification System from scratch, schema to UI.
- **Product Specialist | Apr 2022 – Dec 2023**
  - Built RBAC and multi-tenant security in-house, from scratch.

    - Optimised APIs and DB queries. Cut response times by ~40%.
    - Pushed the team onto iterative agile delivery. Cut release cycles by 1.5x.
- **Full Stack Developer | Jun 2020 – Mar 2022**
    - Delivered SaaS features across the full stack. Used lazy-loading and modular design to keep the frontend scalable as usage grew past thousands of active users in quick turnaround cycles.

Manaraah | Jan 2020 – Jun 2020

- **Senior Full Stack Developer**
    - Built and deployed cloud-native, AI-powered business applications for clients moving off legacy systems in the construction domain.
    - Worked directly with clients to turn raw requirements into working software.

WeCP (We Create Problems) | Jan 2019 – Jan 2020

- **Software Development Engineer**
    - Built highly available SaaS platforms used for technical hiring.
    - Shaped and headed a mentorship program for interns and junior engineers.

Reubro International | Aug 2018 – Jan 2019

- **Junior Programmer**
    - Worked on reliability and usability improvements to the company's main SaaS products.

TOP PROJECTS

- **Booklet:** Markdown-to-shareable-page SaaS on Next.js and MongoDB, publishable from the web, an npm CLI, REST API, GitHub Action or MCP server, all on one conversion pipeline. Own auth (argon2id, passkeys) and a unit-tested SSRF guard.
- **BRNR:** Account-free encrypted chat with 24-hour message expiry. X3DH handshake into a Double Ratchet (own @brnr/e2ee library), so the server only ever handles ciphertext; Redis with TTLs is the sole datastore. NestJS, Socket.IO, React, Expo.
- **Wayfarer:** Local-first, in-browser API client (Angular, IndexedDB) with an encrypted secrets vault: PBKDF2 at 600,000 iterations wraps an AES-GCM-256 key held only in memory. 94 public claims, each tied to tests in Chromium, Firefox and WebKit.
- **Weir:** Open-source Go HTTP cache that shields an origin from mass expiry (shared origin limiter, lifetime jitter, stale serving). Load test: 10,000 simultaneously expired keys, never more than 32 requests in flight. Fuzzed.

- **better-auth-mongoose:** Published npm adapter that lets Better Auth use real Mongoose models, restoring populate() that the official MongoDB adapter breaks. Passes Better Auth's adapter conformance suite; NestJS example app runs in CI.
- **Also built:** WorkDeck (Claude Code plugin that splits work into scoped cards, with scope and test gates and a separate reviewer agent), loupe (design-review skill that checks UIs against Apple's Human Interface Guidelines), humanize-writing-skill (writing skill tested in 18 blind pairs).

EDUCATION

National Institute of Technology, Calicut
B.Tech., Electronics & Communication Engineering (2014 – 2018)